THE KUSHAQ OF SAFETY

The Kushaq has scored 5 stars for both adult occupant protection and child occupant protection. What makes this achievement significant are the new stringent GNCAP rules





Petr Solc, brand director, Skoda Auto India

SAFETY IS AN ESSENTIAL PART OF OUR BRAND DNA. IT IS A PROUD MOMENT FOR ALL OF US AT SKODA TO HAVE INDIA'S SAFEST FAMILY CAR LEADING OUR GROWTH

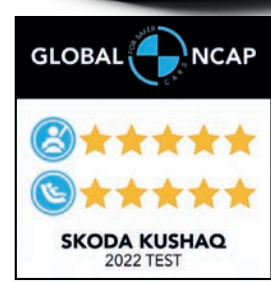
Skoda is an automaker that has been acclaimed for its build quality which has helped position the Czech brand as one of the most sought-after in the Indian market. In recent times, Skoda has been on a growth path spearheaded by the INDIA 2.0 brand strategy, the project which developed the MQB-A0-IN, a localised version of Volkswagen Group's global platform that underpins the Kushaq and the Slavia.

Incorporating localisation, the MQB-A0-IN provides an ideal platform that lends a sporty and comfortable character to the Kushaq. But its biggest asset is in fact its safety which has been proved by the latest round of the Global NCAP crash tests in which the Kushaq has scored a full 5 stars. Moreover, the SUV is the first Indian vehicle to undergo the revised GNCAP test which has more stringent criteria for testing. While India has of late been producing safer cars, many of which have been awarded 5 stars by GNCAP under the older testing protocols, the Kushaq is the first and the only car to score 5 stars in both adult and child protection criteria.

Scoring 29.64 out of 34 points for adult occupant protection and 42 out of 49 points for child occupant protection the Skoda Kushaq has aced the new GNCAP crash test. Amongst the changes compared to the older GNCAP protocols are the more stringent chest load readings from the crash test dummies, compulsory side impact tests, child test dummies for side impact test, mandatory Electronic Stability Control on tested vehicles, as well as a revised scoring criteria.

The Skoda Kushaq boasts of a safety suite comprising Electronic Stability Control, ABS and EBD, Multi Collision Braking, Electronic Differential Lock System, Brake Disc Wiping, Roll Over Protection, Traction Control System, Hill Hold Control, three point seat belts and height adjustable head restraints for all occupants, driver and passenger front airbag, curtain airbags, front side airbags and ISOFIX mounts.





Assessed in its most basic safety specification, it recieved a "stable" rating for bodyshell integrity in a frontal impact. This means that while the long list of active safety features adds an impressive protection net, in the case of the Kushaq it is the added benefit of a sound chassis structure that makes the car safe for occupants. The safety rating is yet another feather in the cap for the Skoda Kushaq which has taken its segment by storm powered by powerful, refined and fuel efficient TSI engines.